

POINT OF VIEW · VOLUME II · 2026

Price is a *decision*, not a default.

A point of view for retail and commercial banking heads on the revenue lever most GCC banks never pull deliberately.

THE ARGUMENT

The revenue you have *already* earned.

Before winning new customers, collect what existing ones already owe.

Tariffs age quietly. Fee schedules are set at launch and rarely revisited. Products change, competitors move and customers shift to digital channels, but the tariff still describes the bank of five years ago.

Exceptions become the price. Waivers granted to win or keep a relationship are seldom reviewed. Over time the discount becomes the norm, and the published tariff describes what almost nobody pays.

Nobody owns the number. Pricing sits between product, finance, sales and risk. Each can change it and none is accountable for the revenue it produces. The lever moves by accident rather than by decision.

“*A waiver nobody reviews is a price nobody chose.*”

THE DIAGNOSTIC

Five places revenue *leaks*.

01	Unreviewed waivers	Relationship waivers granted once and never revisited.	WHERE TO LOOK Waiver volumes by approver, segment and reason.
02	Uncollected fees	Charges in the tariff that systems do not apply, or apply inconsistently.	WHERE TO LOOK Fee income set against transaction volumes.
03	Legacy tariffs	Customers on grandfathered pricing for products that have since changed.	WHERE TO LOOK Accounts on closed or superseded tariffs.
04	Mispriced risk	Lending rates that do not reflect the capital and risk each exposure consumes.	WHERE TO LOOK Risk-adjusted return by portfolio and segment.
05	Undifferentiated bundles	Packages that give every customer the same value, whatever they actually use.	WHERE TO LOOK Bundle take-up against feature usage.

Aspiro pricing diagnostic framework.



THE FRAMEWORK

A pricing study in four *steps*.

01

Establish the baseline

Fee and rate income by product, segment and channel, with leakage quantified line by line.

02

Benchmark value, not only competitors

Customer willingness to pay alongside competitor tariffs, so price reflects the value delivered.

03

Redesign the tariff

Fee structures, rate cards and bundles designed with the proposition, then tested with customers and frontline teams.

04

Govern the exceptions

A pricing committee, limits by role and a quarterly review of waivers, so the gain survives the study.



CASE STUDY

Price and proposition, designed *together*.

A digital-only offering that onboards a customer in minutes can command a different fee structure from a branch-served account. Here, pricing and product were designed together.

Minutes

ONBOARDING TIME, DOWN FROM DAYS

Omnichannel strategy & digital banking launch

Local bank, GCC

THE CHALLENGE

A local bank was losing the next generation of customers to digital challengers and neighbouring incumbents. Onboarding took days, the branch-led model was expensive, and the technology estate could not support a modern proposition.

WHAT WE DID

Designed the omnichannel strategy and digital-only proposition, selected and architected a cloud-native platform, launched WhatsApp banking and instant digital onboarding, and ran the programme through to launch.

THE OUTCOME

Onboarding in minutes rather than days, a dramatically reduced cost-to-income ratio for the digital proposition, and a customer base skewed to the younger segments the bank had been losing.

Minutes

Onboarding, down from days

Next-gen

Customers won by a digital-only launch

C/I down

Cost-to-income tracked from launch

Four questions for the next pricing *committee*.

01

Who owns the number?

Name one executive accountable for fee and rate income, not only for volume.

02

What did we waive?

Last quarter's waivers by approver, segment and reason, and which were reviewed.

03

What do we fail to collect?

Fees in the tariff that the systems do not charge, or charge inconsistently.

04

When did we last test price?

Against customer value and cost to serve, not only against the bank next door.

Leading with clarity.
Delivering the *difference*.

Start a conversation

ABOUT ASPIRO

Aspiro is an independent, investor-free management consultancy for GCC financial institutions, founded in Dubai in 2015 with offices in Riyadh and London. Its partners carry 100+ years of senior leadership experience, backed by a network of 8,000+ specialists.

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